

an era of globalisation where trade barriers dropped and there was free flow of money. What we have seen increasingly over the past decade is that order being broken. And it has been broken by those who were trusted to keep it going.

Globalisation, per se, was very, very successful in terms of global wealth creation. What went wrong with the global order was it was exclusive. It excluded very large portions of the global population. The political framework of every country has moved dramatically to the right as a result of the exclusion. If I have semiconductor chips, I won't let you have it. The powers that be have lost the trust of the people, but no one else has won it yet. A new world order has to, by definition, be more representative of the global population. It must be built on the foundation of peace.

Q: How long will business have to wait for a new order, given that it cannot function in a vacuum?

A: Very hard to guess. I think business will, in the meantime, find ways to survive and get to the other side. New trade routes will be developed, and more resilience will be built into businesses. The just-in-time, cheapest, most efficient is something of the days gone by. You have to deal with redundancies and the costs associated with them. Everybody also asks me, who is going to bear the cost? The answer is easy—the consumer. And it is only then that the politicians will come together and find a solution.

Q: Will Dubai's role as a transshipment hub change permanently, or will things return to the way they were after the conflict ends?

A: It depends on the nature of the end of the conflict. We all must hope that it is a negotiated settlement between interested parties, so that there is status quo in terms of open and free waterways. Water accounts for more than 80% global trade. Any form of disruption or blocking of access to waterways will impact the cost of trade, the cost of transportation, the cost of the supply chain. The fact that one needs to buy from the other is not going to change. What will change is, if I was earlier buying 90% from China, I will buy 60%. If I was buying